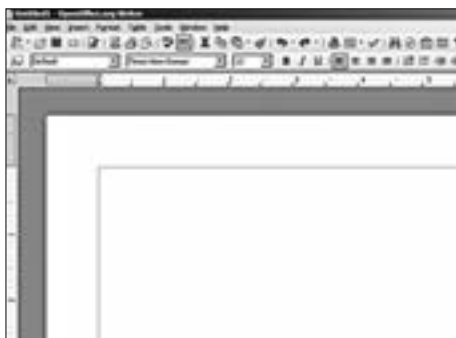


1.2 Writer

Most of us need to do a little word processing from time to time. Whether it's writing a letter, a memo or even an entire book, we need word processing software to make it easier. Windows ships with Notepad and WordPad by default; these allow you to type out stuff, and behave like very elementary word processors, but are nothing like Microsoft Word or OpenOffice.org's Writer. A fully-packed word processor includes features such as auto-complete and auto-correct, formatting and styles, a dictionary and thesaurus, and many more features that make word processing on a PC a snap.

1.2.1 The Interface

When you start Writer, you are greeted by a blank document called `Untitled1`—pretty standard for most software. The menu bar is at the top left, as with most software, and below that you will find the Standard Toolbar, which contains com-



The interface you'll see when you start up Writer

mon functions that you'll use when doing your word processing. Directly below the Standard Toolbar is the Formatting Toolbar. This contains everything you need to format your document, such as setting text to bold, italics, underline, or adding highlighting, changing fonts, font sizes, etc.

You can just hover over any button and a tool-tip will tell you that button's name. However, if you are a beginner at using such applications, you might need a little extra help. You can turn on extended tool tips to get more information. Just go to **Tools** >